AppBuildersPH Hackathon 2026: Local AI Guide

> This guide only reorganizes what is in the official materials and your notes. No rules were added. Where the sources disagree or are cut off, it is flagged in **Things to Confirm** at the bottom.

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1. The Big Picture

Theme: Local AI

One-line goal: Build a **working product** where **meaningful AI computation runs on the user's device**, and show **why running it locally is better** than cloud-only.

Important distinction: Local AI is *not* "an AI product for a local (Filipino) audience." It means AI that runs **locally on the device**.

Cloud services: allowed or not?

- Yes, cloud APIs and external APIs are allowed **as secondary components**.
- The **core / meaningful AI functionality must run locally**.
- The core Local AI functionality **must not depend entirely on a cloud AI API**.

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2. Key Dates and Timeline

When	What
Fri, Oct 9 (Build Day)	Fully remote, teams build overnight
Sat, Oct 10, 10:00 AM	**Submission deadline. No extensions.**
Sat, Oct 10, 1:00 PM	Finalists announced (on Demo Day)
Sat, Oct 10, 1:40 PM onward	Finalist pitching
Sat, Oct 10, 7:00 PM	Event ends

Your notes summarize the build window as **1 PM to 10 AM (Fri to Sat)** and Pitch Day as **1 PM to 7 PM** (only finalists pitch).

Build Day schedule (Friday, October 9, online)

Time	Activity
1:30 PM	Online room opens
1:45 PM	Participant briefing
2:00 PM	Official challenge reveal
2:10 PM	Rules and judging criteria
2:20 PM	Sponsor resources and credits
2:30 PM	**Building begins**
6:00 PM	Optional community check-in
10:00 PM	Optional community check-in
Overnight	Teams continue building

Demo Day schedule (Saturday, October 10, Cyberzone, SM Makati)

Time	Activity
12:00 PM	Registration and participant arrival
12:15 PM	Demo and AV technical checks
1:00 PM	Official opening and AppBuildersPH welcome (**finalists announced**)
1:15 PM	PExpress welcome
1:20 PM	AMD segment
1:30 PM	Cognition / Devin segment
1:40 PM	Finalist pitching begins
3:20 PM	Break and networking
3:40 PM	Finalist pitching continues
5:00 PM	Judging deliberation, PC Express auction and raffle
5:45 PM	Awards ceremony
6:30 PM	Networking
7:00 PM	Event ends

3. Flow at a Glance

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Register (official website list)
        ↓
Build Day: build the working product (Oct 9, 2:30 PM start, overnight)
        ↓
Record a short demo video and post it on X or LinkedIn
        ↓
Submit everything by 10:00 AM, Oct 10
        ↓
Submission screening (checklist check; incomplete = invalid)
        ↓
Finalists announced at 1:00 PM, Oct 10
        ↓
Finalists pitch live at Cyberzone: 5 min pitch + demo, 3 min Q&A
        ↓
Judging, People's Choice vote, awards ceremony
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4. Rules

Required

- **Substantially built during the hackathon.**
- **A meaningful part of AI inference executes locally.**
- **A working product, demonstrated.** Not Figma, not slides (PPT), etc.
- **Models, APIs, frameworks, and major tools are disclosed.**
- **Core Local AI functionality works without depending entirely on a cloud AI API.**

Allowed

- Existing open-source models and libraries
- AI-assisted development
- Devin
- Cloud APIs as secondary components
- Using open-source AI to train AI (from your notes)

Not allowed / disqualifying

- Not following the rules ("strictly follow rules").
- A project that wasn't substantially built during the hackathon (existing code must be disclosed).

- Receiving help from **people outside the hackathon**. Participants **proven** to have received external help are disqualified.
- A team that is **not represented in person at Demo Day** cannot be a finalist (see Section 8).

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5. What Counts as Local AI

In scope (examples from the brief):

- Local LLMs
- Local vision models
- Local speech recognition
- Local embeddings and RAG
- Local AI agents
- Local image generation
- Edge AI
- Offline AI
- Privacy-preserving AI
- Hybrid local + cloud systems
- AI on PCs, laptops, phones, or edge hardware

Product types (any kind is welcome): Productivity, creative tools, developer tools, enterprise tools, accessibility, education, finance, gaming, disaster-related, computer vision, personal assistants, privacy tools, etc.

Format is flexible. It does not have to be a mobile app. It can be a web app, Chrome extension, mobile app, or something running on hardware.

Example technologies (none are required): Ollama, LM Studio, Llama.cpp, MLX, ONNX, PyTorch, TensorFlow, WebGPU, Core ML, AMD ROCm, DirectML, Hugging Face, plus open-source LLMs, vision models, and speech models.

No specific model, framework, operating system, or hardware platform is required.

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6. How You'll Be Scored

Weight	Criterion	Question the judges ask
25%	Problem & Usefulness	Does it solve a genuine problem for a clear target user?
25%	Implementation	Is local inference fundamental, and does it give a meaningful advantage?
20%	Technical Execution	Does it actually work, reliably enough for a live demo?
15%	Innovation	Is it meaningfully different? Does Local AI enable something new?
15%	Product & Demo Quality	Is the UX usable, and is the live demo convincing?

Takeaway from the organizers: Half the score is usefulness plus how real your Local AI is (Problem & Usefulness + Implementation).

Same idea as another team? It depends on how the team executed the solution.

Judges: 10 judges, announced on Demo Day.

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7. Submission

Deadline: 10:00 AM, October 10. No extensions. Only one submission (project) per team.

Submission checklist

If your submission is missing items, it is **screened as an invalid submission before it reaches the judges.**

The project

- [ ] Project name
- [ ] Short description
- [ ] Team members
- [ ] Public GitHub repository

The proof

- [ ] Demo video
- [ ] X / LinkedIn video URL
- [ ] What runs locally
- [ ] What requires internet

The disclosures

- [ ] Models used
- [ ] Technologies and frameworks
- [ ] APIs and cloud services
- [ ] Existing code and assets
- [ ] AI development tools

The question every submission must answer

> **Why does this product benefit from running AI locally?**

(From the brief: show how local AI creates an experience that would be difficult, expensive, slow, private, or impossible with a cloud-only approach.)

"What runs locally" and "what requires internet"

Disclose both **in paragraph format**.

Demo video requirements

- **Edited**, showing a **working demo** of your product.
- **Less than 1 minute** (the FAQ says "ideally around 1 minute").
- **Must be posted on X or LinkedIn. This is a hard requirement.**
- Include the hashtag **#AppBuildersPH**.
- Tag **Devin** / **Cognition**.

Do you need to deploy the app live?

- **No**, as long as your repository has instructions for judges to recreate it.
- From your notes: **deployed projects get a huge bonus**, and you must have **clear instructions** on how it works or how to recreate it.

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8. Demo Day (Finalists)

Who becomes a finalist?

- Announced on **October 10 at 1:00 PM**.
- **10 to 15** finalist teams (your notes say a minimum of 10, depending on venue capacity, and are marked "not sure yet").
- **Only finalists pitch.**

Attendance rules

- Everyone is welcome at Demo Day.
- To be a finalist, the team must be **at Cyberzone, SM Makati, in person**.

- **At least one representative per team must be present.** If no one is present, the team is **disqualified from finalist**.
- **Remote pitching is not allowed.** Someone from your team must be on site to pitch and answer the judges' Q&A.

Pitch format (per team)

Segment	Time
Pitch and live demo	**5 minutes**
Judge Q&A	**3 minutes**
Total	**8 minutes**

Tip from the organizers: Prioritize showing a working product over presenting a large number of slides.

Logistics

- Wi-Fi, power outlets, and HDMI and USB-C connections are available.
- **Bring your own laptop to demo on.**
- Coffee and sandwiches are provided.
- Guests are welcome to watch the pitches.
- Concerns on Demo Day: contact **Bryl Lim** or any organizing member.

9. Prizes

Award	Prize	Notes
Grand Champion	**₱50,000**	Best overall project. Cash, AMD / ASUS peripherals, Devin AI credits
WhiteCloak Award	**₱15,000**	Cash, WhiteCloak merch (1st runner-up per your notes)
AMD Award	**₱10,000**	Cash, AMD / ASUS peripherals (3rd place per your notes)
Cognition / Devin Award	**₱10,000**	Cash
Tutorials Dojo Award	**₱10,000**	Cash
People's Choice Award	**₱10,000**	Audience vote during Demo Day

Other prize details:

- Per the brief, there are **four winners at ₱10,000 cash each** in the "Top" group. Your notes describe this as 4th to 8th place from Devin and other sponsors. Special awards may be added.
- **People's Choice:** A QR code is shown. Everyone at the venue scans it to vote for a pitch, and the highest vote wins. The same QR scans are also used for the raffle.
- **If the Grand Champion also wins People's Choice, the prize adds to their prize pool.**
- **One project can win more than one award.** Special awards are won independently of the main award.
- **Cash prizes** are paid by bank transfer to an authorized representative from each winning team.
- **You keep ownership** of what you build.
- **Certificates of participation** are available on the AppBuildersPH website.

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10. Teams

- **Who can compete:** Only participants listed on the official website, **appbuildersph.com/hackathon**. **All members must be registered.**
- **Team size:** 1 to 4 members recommended. Solo builders are allowed.
- **One project per team.**
- **One person, one team.** Nobody can join more than one team.
- **Changing teams or team name:** Allowed, as long as you submit your official team name and member names from the official website list. Your notes say the team name can be changed once you submit.
- **If a member drops out:** Only the member names in your submission are counted.
- **Number of teams:** No cap.

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11. Quick FAQ

Can we use cloud APIs? Yes, as secondary components. Core Local AI must not depend entirely on a cloud AI API.

Can we use open-source models and libraries? Yes. Disclose every model, framework, and API.

Do we need a specific model, OS, or hardware? No.

Can we use AI coding tools like Devin? Yes. Disclose the tools you used. (Devin AI credits are limited to students. Stay posted.)

Can we reuse code from before the hackathon? Your project must be substantially built during the hackathon. Disclose any existing code or assets.

Can people outside the hackathon help us? No.

Can we build from anywhere? Yes. Build Day is fully remote.

Where do we ask questions during the build? The official Telegram group chat.

Can the project be a mobile app or run on hardware? Yes.

Can results be disputed? Yes, if a team is proven to have violated the rules (including a pre-existing project or external help).

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12. Links

- Official hackathon website: **appbuildersph.com/hackathon**
- Hackathon page: **cerebralvalley.ai/e/appbuildersph-hackathon-2026**
- Telegram group chat: **t.me/+uxLZLV5...** (the link in the source was garbled, so use the one in the official materials)

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13. Final Checklist

Before building

- [ ] Everyone on the team is registered on the official website
- [ ] Project idea has meaningful AI running **locally**

While building

- [ ] Building during the hackathon (disclose any pre-existing code or assets)
- [ ] Keep track of every model, framework, API, cloud service, and AI tool you use
- [ ] Repo is **public** on GitHub, with instructions for judges to recreate it

Before 10:00 AM, Oct 10

- [ ] Edited demo video (under about 1 minute) showing the working product
- [ ] Posted on X or LinkedIn with **#AppBuildersPH** and tagging **Devin** / **Cognition**
- [ ] Project name, short description, team members
- [ ] "What runs locally" and "what requires internet" written in paragraph format
- [ ] All disclosures complete
- [ ] Answered: **Why does this product benefit from running AI locally?**

Demo Day

- [ ] At least one team representative at Cyberzone, SM Makati
- [ ] Own laptop ready, with the product working
- [ ] 5-minute pitch plus live demo prepared, ready for 3 minutes of Q&A

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14. Things to Confirm

The sources conflict or are incomplete in a few places, so verify with the organizers (Telegram group or Bryl Lim):

1. **Build start time:** Notes say "1 PM to 10 AM," while the official schedule says building begins at **2:30 PM**.
2. **Prize structure:** Notes list 3rd place (AMD) and 4th to 8th place (sponsors), while the PDF lists named awards (Cognition/Devin, Tutorials Dojo, AMD, and a fourth ₱10,000 award whose name is cut off in the source).
3. **Finalist count:** Notes say a minimum of 10 (not sure), while the FAQ says 10 to 15.
4. **Demo video length:** Notes say less than 1 minute, while the FAQ says ideally around 1 minute.
5. **Deployment bonus:** Notes say deployed projects get a "huge bonus," while the FAQ only says deployment is not required.
6. **Truncated text:** The external help disqualification line and the dispute line were cut off in the source.
7. **Telegram link:** Garbled in the source.